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"KALAGRIHA"
Reimagining Performing Arts Infrastructure in Belagavi

Abstract
Belagavi, located at the Kannada–Marathi linguistic border, has historically functioned as a vital cultural confluence for theatre, music, and performance-based practices. Touring Sangeet Natak troupes, folk-modern Kannada theatre, bilingual drama movements, and later experimental practices once sustained a lively artistic ecosystem in the city. However, in recent decades, this ecosystem has weakened due to ageing performance infrastructure, rising venue costs, fragmented institutional support, linguistic polarisation, the dominance of digital entertainment, and the migration of young artists to metropolitan centres. Despite strong cultural memory and continued grassroots interest, Belagavi lacks an integrated spatial framework that can support contemporary theatre and filmmaking practices.
This research explores how architecture can act as a cultural catalyst in reviving the performing arts ecosystem of a mid-sized Indian city. Using a mixed-methods approach—combining historical documentation, literature review, stakeholder interviews, survey analysis, and comparative national and international case studies—the study identifies critical infrastructural, social, and operational gaps within Belagavi's cultural landscape. A three-tier survey involving the public, students, and practicing artists reveals converging concerns: limited affordable rehearsal spaces, absence of multilingual and interdisciplinary platforms, inadequate technical facilities, and lack of continuity in artistic engagement. In response to these findings, the research advocates for a multifunctional Arts Centre that integrates theatre, filmmaking, digital labs, training spaces, and open cultural commons. Conceived as an inclusive and accessible urban institution, the project positions architecture not merely as a container for performance but as an active agent in cultural revival, identity negotiation, and long-term artistic resilience within a linguistically layered urban context.

Keywords: Performing Arts, Cultural Infrastructure, Multi-disciplinary Arts Centre, Urban Cultural Development, Linguistic Identity.

1. Introduction and Background

Theatre and cinema have historically functioned as mirrors of society, expressing collective memory, cultural identity, and socio-political transformation. Across civilisations, performance evolved from ritual practices to modern artistic expressions. Within India, theatre's regional diversity and cinematic traditions remain central to cultural life. Belagavi, positioned at a linguistic and cultural crossroads, becomes an essential site to study how architecture can support theatre and filmmaking in a rapidly evolving creative ecosystem.

India's performance history spans classical Sanskrit dramaturgy, regional and folk traditions, colonial proscenium culture, and modern institutional theatre. Courtly, temple, and travelling performers shaped early practice, while the colonial period introduced print, commercial circuits, and modern stagecraft. Post-independence, state institutions, experimental groups, and regional modernisms in Karnataka and Maharashtra expanded Indian theatre's reach. These multi-layered developments directly inform Belagavi's cultural evolution, where Marathi and Kannada traditions meet, adapt, and influence one another within a unique borderland performance ecology. [1] [4] [5]

1.1. Why Belagavi as the site?

Belagavi occupies a culturally strategic position within India's socio-political landscape. Located at the Karnataka–Maharashtra border, it represents one of the most prominent linguistic interface zones in post-independence India. The city has historically been central to debates on state reorganization, linguistic identity, and cultural belonging, making it not merely a peripheral town but a nationally symbolic borderland. This dual Kannada–Marathi influence has produced a distinctive hybrid cultural ecosystem reflected in theatre traditions, literary movements, folk performance forms, and bilingual artistic production. Unlike metropolitan cultural capitals shaped by singular dominant narratives, Belagavi embodies a negotiated identity. Its performance culture emerges from coexistence, contestation, and cultural overlap. Folk forms such as Yakshagana, influences from Karnataka, intersect with Marathi Sangeet Natak traditions, generating a layered performance vocabulary. The city has also produced notable theatre practitioners and maintains an active amateur theatre circuit supported by community institutions and local academies.

At a national level, border cities such as Belagavi serve as cultural laboratories where questions of language, identity, and artistic expression intersect with spatial politics. Belagavi's borderland identity creates a unique Kannada–Marathi cultural overlap. It has strong theatre roots, emerging film aspirations, and youth-driven creative interest, yet lacks an integrated arts infrastructure to support contemporary practices. [2] [8] This study frames theatre and filmmaking as culturally symbolic and spatial practices. Through historical analysis, site study, interviews, and design inquiry, the thesis identifies infrastructural gaps and argues for Kalagriha as an essential architectural intervention supporting Belagavi's creative future.

1.2. Important Modern Theatre Movements in Karnataka and Maharashtra

The evolution of modern Indian theatre shaped Belagavi's bilingual performance culture by merging Karnataka and Maharashtra influences. Karnataka's Navya Modernism—through Karnad, Kambara, and Lankesh—introduced existential, folk-modern dramaturgy that became staples in Belagavi's college festivals. B.V. Karanth's musical theatre inspired local troupes to experiment with rhythm-based ensemble work, while Samudaya's political theatre brought bilingual street performances into Belagavi's labour colonies. From Maharashtra, IPTA's Progressive Theatre introduced socially realist narratives that Belagavi groups adapted widely in the 1960s–70s. Tendulkar's parallel theatre deepened this influence through urban realism and political critique, shaping both Marathi audiences and Kannada workshop practices. Contemporary experimentalists like Alekar and Elkunchwar further encouraged minimalist, psychological staging adopted by Belagavi's youth clubs. Collectively, these movements created the hybrid, socially aware, bilingual theatre ecology central to Belagavi's cultural identity.

1.3. Belagavi as a Cultural Confluence for Marathi and Kannada Theatre

Belagavi's theatre has been shaped by iconic Marathi figures, and their contributions span musical theatre, experimental modernism, folk integration, scenographic innovation, and cross-regional

collaboration. Many toured or performed in Belagavi, linking Maharashtra's Sangeet Natak legacy with Karnataka's folk-modern hybrid stagecraft and directly influencing local troupes, Natya Mandirs, and audience culture.

Table 1.3 — Timeline of Theatre Influences in Belagavi

Period	**Marathi Influence**	**Kannada Influence**	**Resulting Theatre Culture in Belagavi**
Late 1800s – Early 1900s	Touring Sangeet Natak troupes introduce musical drama.	Local village drama groups begin open-air performances.	Early Cross-Cultural Performances: The Foundation of Theatre Appreciation.
1920s–1940s	Lokmanya Rang Mandir becomes a Marathi theatre hub; nationalist plays are performed.	Kannada Bhavan formalises theatre training & competitions.	Introduction of structured rehearsal culture; bilingual audience formation.
1950s–1970s	Gokhte Rang Mandir (Biscuit Mahadev era) popularises street/fusion theatre.	Kannada Natya Mandirs expand regional folk-based drama.	Hybrid Marathi–Kannada dramatic forms; folk + social critique emerge.
1980s–2000s	Experimental Marathi scripts enter college festivals and city halls.	Kannada plays incorporate literature, folk hybrids, and modernist scripts.	Heightened coexistence; bilingual scripts emerge; collaborative teams formed.
2000s–Present	Annual Marathi theatre festivals bring major troupes to Belagavi.	Kannada competitions, school drama movement, and modern auditoriums grow.	Belagavi becomes a cultural confluence point, producing bilingual actors, writers, and directors.

2. Socio-political and Cultural dynamics

Belagavi's socio-political landscape has been shaped for decades by linguistic contestation between Karnataka and Maharashtra, rooted in the 1956 States Reorganisation Act. While Marathi political groups (MES) continue to advocate for merger with Maharashtra, the city today functions as Karnataka's second legislative capital, embodying a pragmatic bilingual equilibrium. This dual identity reflects in Belagavi's cultural and performing arts ecology: theatres, artists, institutions, and audiences continuously navigate linguistic preferences, caste–community dynamics, industrial and educational economic structures, climatic constraints, and stakeholder negotiations. Together, these forces define how artistic spaces evolve and how the proposed *KALAGRIHA* can address existing gaps.

2.1. Impact of Linguistic politics on Cultural identity and Performing arts

Belagavi's bilingual character—Marathi-speaking communities intertwined with Kannada-speaking majorities—creates layered cultural identities that directly influence theatre patronage, programming, and space utilisation. Marathi audiences historically support spaces such as Lokmanya Rang Mandir, while Kannada groups gravitate toward Kannada Bhavan and local Natya Mandirs. Linguistic

affiliations shape audience patterns, political pressures occasionally dictate programming priorities, and funding is often language-aligned. Yet this duality also fosters innovation: bilingual plays, hybrid dramaturgies, and collaborative productions have emerged as a response to cultural tension, creating Belagavi's distinctive theatrical vocabulary where Marathi narrative clarity meets Kannada folk energy.



Fig 1: The Belagavi Conundrum
Source: The Times of India

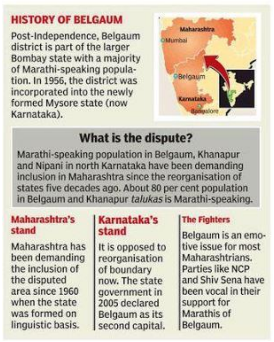


Fig 2: History of Belgaum.
Source: The Times of India

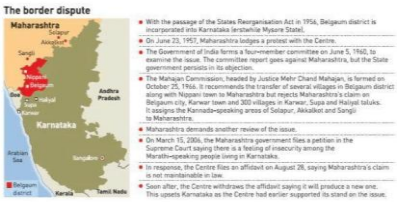


Fig 3: The border dispute
Source: The Times of India

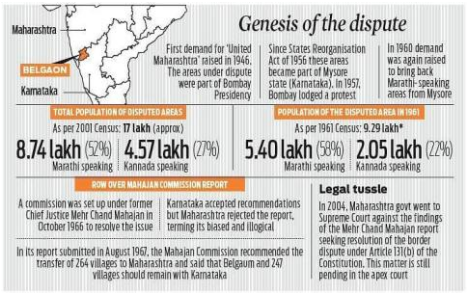


Fig 4: Genesis of the Dispute
Source: The Times of India

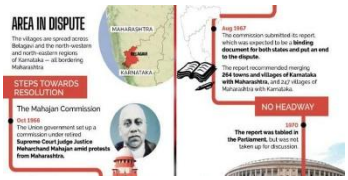


Fig 5: Areaa in Dispute
Source: The Times of India

2.2. Influence of Religion, Caste and Community Identities

Belagavi's performing arts reflect deeply embedded social structures. Religious festivals act as natural performance platforms; temple committees often fund or curate plays rooted in sacred narratives. Caste-linked traditional art forms—puppetry, folk-dance, travelling theatre—continue to inform performer identity and skill transmission, though access to resources remains uneven. Community organisations tied to linguistic or regional identity further shape what gets performed and who participates, influencing inclusivity, artistic trajectory, and public access. These layered identities create both opportunities (diverse content, rich traditional vocabulary) and constraints (representation gaps, resource asymmetry).

2.3. Economic structure

Belagavi's economy is anchored in foundries, textiles, transport industries, and a growing educational hub supports a vibrant but uneven arts ecosystem. Students from engineering, commerce, and arts colleges drive amateur theatre and short filmmaking initiatives, though their involvement is often inconsistent due to academic demands. Industrial units occasionally sponsor events, but support tends to favour high-visibility rather than experimental art.

Government funding is often irregular, language-sensitive, and bureaucratic. Established theatre groups dominate visibility, sometimes sidelining emerging artists. Colleges supply talent but rarely provide sustained infrastructural support. Private sponsorship prioritises commercial, short-term returns. These competing interests generate clashes over venue access, resources, and programming priorities, but also create opportunities for collaboration through festivals, workshops, bilingual initiatives, and institutional partnerships.

2.4. Assessment of existing Natya Mandirs and Cultural centres

Belagavi hosts multiple cultural venues, yet many now operate under commercial pressures. High rental charges, limited availability, and outdated facilities restrict student groups and emerging artists. Programming priorities favour revenue-heavy events; modular rehearsal spaces or subsidised access are scarce.

Table 2.4 — Belagavi Cultural Venues Overview

Venue	Facilities	Rental (₹/day)	Restrictions	Impact
Gogte Rang Mandir	Large hall, basic tech	10k–12k	Limited slots	Hard for student groups
Lokmanya Rang Mandir	Good acoustics	8k–12k	High demand	Favours commercial shows
Varekar Natya Sangh	Minimal tech	5k–7k	Maintenance issues	Limits quality rehearsal
Kannada Bhavan	Modern hall	12k–15k	Bureaucratic access	Restricts emerging artists
Kumar Gandharva Kala Mandir	Community hall	4k–6k	Not theatre-oriented	Low suitability
Dr. Jirge Auditorium	Advanced tech	15k–20k	High cost	Inaccessible to the grassroots

As a result, creativity is stifled, traditional forms lack nurturing spaces, and grassroots theatre struggles for survival. The existing infrastructure demonstrates the need for an accessible, multi-format, artist-friendly cultural complex with rehearsal studios, black-box spaces, flexible amphitheatres, and subsidised community access. [10] [11]

In response to these challenges, Kalagriha is envisioned as a people-oriented cultural space rather than a profit-driven venue. Rooted in architectural sustainability and affordability, the project uses cost-efficient construction methods and low-maintenance design strategies to reduce both initial and long-term expenses. This allows rental charges to remain minimal and flexible, ensuring access for students, amateur theatre groups, and emerging artists. While selected larger events will help support operational costs, the primary goal is community benefit, not revenue maximization. Through rehearsal studios, black-box theatres, and open shared spaces, Kalagriha aims to function as an accessible, government-supported cultural hub that strengthens Belagavi's artistic ecosystem.

3. Methodology

This study adopts a qualitative–analytical research framework integrating historical inquiry, stakeholder-based data collection, and comparative case study analysis to examine the decline of performing arts infrastructure in Belagavi and evaluate the role of architectural intervention in cultural revival. The methodology is structured to ensure contextual rigour, interdisciplinary relevance, and design-based applicability. The research is organised into four sequential stages: contextual mapping, primary stakeholder engagement, comparative case analysis, and design synthesis.

3.1 Contextual and Historical Mapping

A historical and spatial mapping of Belagavi's performing arts ecosystem was undertaken to establish its cultural trajectory. Archival records, secondary literature, institutional documents, and newspaper sources were reviewed to trace the evolution of theatre practices and the transformation of key venues, including Lokmanya Rangamandir and Gogte Rangamandir. This mapping enabled the identification of patterns related to bilingual cultural exchange, touring theatre networks, infrastructural decline, and shifts in audience engagement. The findings contextualise Belagavi as a borderland cultural node with significant historical potential yet diminishing contemporary activation.

3.2 Stakeholder-Based Data Collection

Primary data was gathered through a structured three-tier survey targeting the general public, students, and practising artists. The survey assessed participation patterns, infrastructural accessibility, affordability concerns, and expectations from future cultural facilities. Supplementary qualitative inputs were obtained through stakeholder discussions with theatre practitioners and organisers to understand operational barriers, rental structures, linguistic fragmentation, and migration trends. Responses were thematically coded to identify recurring concerns across user groups.

3.3 Stakeholder-Based Data Collection

Selected national and international case studies were examined based on scale, governance model, affordability, and cultural impact. Indian examples such as Rangashankara and Ninasam were analysed for community-driven theatre ecosystems, while international institutions were evaluated for spatial adaptability and youth engagement strategies. Comparative parameters included spatial flexibility, financial accessibility, programming diversity, and institutional sustainability. Extracted principles were adapted to Belagavi's socio-economic context rather than replicated.

3.4 Data Analysis and Design Synthesis

Findings from historical review, stakeholder data, and case comparisons were synthesised into spatial and operational strategies guiding the proposal of Kalagriha. Core design responses include flexible performance typologies, subsidised rehearsal infrastructure, bilingual neutrality, digital integration, and climate-responsive construction. The methodology positions architectural design not merely as a physical solution but as an analytical framework capable of restructuring cultural participation and institutional accessibility in mid-sized cities.

4. Literature Studies

Literature shows that theatre in border regions like Belagavi is shaped by linguistic politics, caste barriers, and uneven cultural patronage, creating a fragmented arts ecosystem.[4] [5] Studies also highlight economic precarity—high venue rents, weak institutional support, and policy gaps that limit artistic continuity.[6] [7] Digital research notes how OTT platforms have reduced live-theatre audiences, with smaller cities unable to adopt hybrid models.[8] [9] Overall, scholarship confirms that Belagavi's cultural decline stems from identity divides, financial hurdles, and technological lag, demanding integrated cultural infrastructure and new spatial strategies.

Table 4.1 — Required Research Areas for Belagavi's Art Ecosystem

Research Gap Identified in Literature	**What is Missing**	**Why it Matters for Belagavi**
Lack of documentation of Belagavi's theatre history	No consolidated archives or historical mapping of troupes, venues, or productions	Belagavi's bilingual theatre identity remains invisible in scholarship

Absence of spatial/architectural analysis	No studies link venue design to access, performance diversity, or artist experience	Venue rigidity and rentals directly affect local artists
Minimal research on student/amateur theatre	Youth groups are rarely studied despite their cultural presence	Students are the primary drivers of experimental theatre in Belagavi
No analysis of digital adaptation in small cities	Research focuses on Mumbai/Delhi/Bengaluru, not tier-2 cities	Belagavi faces digital decline without a digital response
Limited examination of linguistic coexistence	Most works study the Marathi–Kannada conflict politically, not culturally	Theatre is where language identities meet, clash, or blend
Economic invisibility of regional artists	Funding barriers are rarely quantified; rental structures are unstudied	Economic exclusion shapes who can perform and sustain careers

4.2 Case-Studies

This sub-chapter reviews key national and international arts institutions to understand how architectural design, cultural policy, and community engagement shape thriving performing arts ecosystems. Indian examples like Rangashankara and Ninasam show how accessible infrastructure and training sustain local theatre cultures, while global models such as the Young Vic and Market Theatre highlight innovation, adaptive reuse, and public participation. These case studies collectively inform strategic directions for developing *KALAGRIHA* into an inclusive, future-ready arts centre for Belagavi.

Table 4.2.1 — Indian Theatre Models – Compact Comparative Insights [12] [13]

Institution	**Core Purpose / Identity**	**Key Strengths**	**Lessons for Belagavi**
Rangashankara, Bengaluru	Affordable, world-class performance venue (2004)	Low rentals, high frequency shows, consistent audience culture	Adopting a low-rent + high-use model can solve Belagavi's venue inaccessibility
Ninasam, Heggodu (Karnataka)	Rural-integrated theatre education & performance (1949)	Community-driven, low-cost, culturally rooted	Community-owned models can help Belagavi create inclusive, sustainable arts ecosystems

Table 4.2.2 — International Theatre Models – Compact Comparative Insights [14] [15]

Institution	**Core Purpose / Identity**	**Key Strengths**	**Lessons for Belagavi**
Young Vic, London (UK)	Accessible, youth-driven, experimental theatre (1970)	Flexible spaces, new writing, strong community outreach	Youth-focused programming + flexible venues can grow new audiences in Belagavi
Market Theatre, Johannesburg (South Africa)	Anti-apartheid, socially engaged theatre (1976)	Courageous programming,	Regional issues + cultural identity can shape powerful, socially relevant theatre in Belagavi

		community-centred activism	

The national case studies show how accessible spaces, strong training ecosystems, and community-focused programming can cultivate local talent into thriving artistic networks. The international examples highlight the power of flexible architecture, experimental freedom, and social engagement in shaping vibrant theatre cultures. Together, they reveal that successful arts centres balance inclusivity, innovation, and identity. For Kalagriha, these insights translate into designing flexible, multilingual, youth-friendly, and digitally equipped spaces that strengthen Belagavi's artistic community. Rather than copying these models, Kalagriha adapts their principles to build a culturally rooted and future-ready performing arts hub for the city.

5. Decline of Existing Theatres in Belagavi

5.1 Historical Value and Cultural Significance

- ***Lokmanya Rangamandir*** (formerly Ritz Theatre): Founded in the late 1920s as Ritz Theatre by Krishnarao Harihar, it began as a film hall before becoming Lokmanya Rangamandir in the 1950s, emerging as Belagavi's key Marathi theatre venue. From the 1930s to 70s, major touring troupes—Natya Vidya Mandir, Rajapurkar Sangeet Mandal, and Kirloskar revival groups—regularly performed here. Artists like Balgandharva, Hansa Wadkar, Shanta Apte, G.D. Madgulkar, and Kashinath Ghanekar strengthened Belagavi–Maharashtra cultural ties. The theatre also supported youth mandals and amateur drama circles, establishing itself as the city's earliest hub for Marathi performing arts.
- ***Gogte Rangamandir*** (formerly School of Culture): Established in the mid-1950s by philanthropist Raosaheb Balkrishna (Bhausaheb) Gogte as the School of Culture, it became Gogte Rangamandir in the early 1960s. It quickly grew into a major centre for theatre, classical dance, Hindustani music, and literary events. Renowned Marathi performers like Dr Shriram Lagoo, Nilu Phule, Bhakti Barve, and Mohan Agashe, along with Kannada stalwarts B.V. Karanth, Girish Karnad, and Chandrashekhara Kambara, shaped its bilingual legacy. Through the 1960s–90s, it remained Belagavi's most refined stage, drawing artists from Pune, Kolhapur, Dharwad, and Bengaluru, and becoming a regional cultural landmark.

5.2 Reasons for Decline

Despite their strong history, both theatres faced a steady decline from the 1990s onward due to:

- Ageing infrastructure and lack of modern acoustics, seating, and digital equipment.
- High rental costs and restrictive booking policies discourage youth groups and emerging troupes.
- Political and linguistic divides, creating fragmented programming and uneven funding.
- Rise of digital media and multiplex culture, reducing live theatre footfall.
- Taxation burdens and insufficient municipal support for maintenance.
- Migration of artists to Pune, Bengaluru, and Mumbai for better opportunities.

Today, both theatres remain structurally functional but are underutilised, primarily hosting occasional competitions, government programs, or commercial events. Regular theatre festivals, repertory activities, and bilingual collaborations have decreased significantly. Youth groups lack affordable access, technical systems are outdated, and there is minimal digital outreach or archival preservation. Despite this decline, the buildings retain strong emotional, historical, and cultural value within Belagavi's artistic community.

5.3 Call for Revival of Existing theatres

The revival of Lokmanya Rangamandir and Gogte Rangamandir is essential to rebuilding Belagavi's cultural foundation. These theatres once embodied the city's unique Kannada–Marathi artistic exchange and served as major platforms for regional drama, music, and public performance. Their current underutilisation stems not from irrelevance, but from ageing infrastructure, limited upgrades, administrative challenges, and changing audience patterns. A conservation-led strategy—focused on structural restoration, improved technical facilities, affordable access for local groups, strengthened bilingual programming, and integration of digital support systems—can restore their public value. Reviving these historic spaces alongside the development of Kalagriha ensures continuity rather than replacement. Together, they can create a layered cultural network: the older theatres preserving legacy and scale, and Kalagriha offering flexible, affordable, and future-ready infrastructure. This combined approach strengthens opportunities for local artists, supports grassroots theatre, and rebuilds a sustainable performing arts ecosystem for Belagavi.

6. Survey Analysis of the Major Stakeholders

A three-level survey was conducted that included about 150 people, which included the general public, artists and the community leaders, to understand Belagavi's cultural needs, current scenario and future expectations. Findings reveal declining engagement with theatre, limited professional spaces, and inadequate exposure to film-making and performing arts. Respondents across all groups highlighted the lack of affordable, modern, and collaborative cultural infrastructure. Many artists and students expressed the need to migrate for training and opportunities.

SECTION A – General Public (Residents & Non-Residents)

Table 6.1 — General Public Key Insights

Factor	**Findings**	**Implication for Kalagriha**
Cultural Awareness	High awareness of Belagavi's theatre legacy, but low recent participation.	Need for consistent programming to rebuild audience culture.
Attendance Barriers	Timing, outdated venues, and low visibility of shows.	Kalagriha must host regular, well-advertised events.
Preferred Activities	Plays, musical nights, film screenings, festivals.	Multipurpose hall + open-air theatre justified.
Public Expectation	Clean, modern, affordable cultural space.	Kalagriha should be accessible and community-centric.

Interpretation: The general public is not disinterested—the infrastructure is inadequate. A new centre can revive the habit of attending live arts, fostering city-level cultural engagement.

SECTION B – Students & Youth (College Groups, Aspiring Artists)

Table 6.2 — Students & Youth Key Insights

Factor	**Findings**	**Implication for Kalagriha**
Interest Levels	The majority are interested in acting, filmmaking, and stagecraft.	Dedicated youth studios and training labs.
Barriers	Lack of rehearsal spaces, equipment, and mentorship.	Professional-grade rehearsal rooms + equipment rental.
Migration Intent	High desire to leave Belagavi for better exposure.	Kalagriha can reduce migration by offering competitive facilities.
Cultural Engagement	Students want workshops, festivals, and beginner-friendly spaces.	Annual youth festivals + mentorship programmes required.

Interpretation: Students do not lack talent—they lack structured pathways. Kalagriha must function as an educational and developmental bridge for the region's youth.

SECTION C – Artistic Community Leaders (Theatre Groups, Productions)

Table 6.3 — Artistic Community Leaders

Factor	**Findings**	**Implication for Kalagriha**
Infrastructure Gaps	Poor acoustics, limited technical facilities in existing halls.	Kalagriha needs modern black-box & proscenium theatres.
Affordability	High costs limit small groups and amateur productions.	Tiered rental policy + subsidised student access.
Professional Needs	Access to lighting, editing labs, prop storage, and rehearsal spaces.	A comprehensive technical suite is essential.
Programming Demand	Desire for bilingual theatre festivals (Kannada + Marathi).	Kalagriha must support cross-cultural programming.

Interpretation: Artists envision Belagavi as a collaborative hub, rather than merely a performance venue. Kalagriha can anchor a sustainable creative ecosystem by aligning professional needs with accessible infrastructure.

Across all three survey levels, the responses converge on the same core issues:

- Infrastructure is the primary barrier, not talent or interest.
- Students and youth are eager to participate but lack entry pathways.
- Artists seek professional-grade, affordable spaces to work regularly.
- The general public will re-engage with the arts if programming is diverse and accessible.
- There is a strong demand for bilingual, inclusive cultural platforms.

- Migration of creative youth can be reduced by providing training + exposure locally.

These insights directly justify the proposal of *Kalagriha* and reinforce its necessity for Belagavi's cultural, educational, and economic revitalisation.

7. Need and Relevance of the Project

Belagavi's performing-arts ecosystem faces six interconnected challenges:

- **Youth & Digital Culture**: Students prefer online entertainment, and outdated venues fail to attract them, resulting in declining participation. A modern arts centre with hybrid digital–stage spaces, informal youth zones, and creative labs can revive engagement.
- **Artist Migration**: Weak funding, limited festivals, and a lack of repertory circuits push emerging artists to metro cities. Residencies, co-working studios, and year-round programming can retain talent and rebuild continuity.
- **Linguistic Divide**: Separate Kannada and Marathi groups create fragmented cultural identities. Neutral multilingual spaces, bilingual festivals, and inclusive governance can foster cohesion and shared cultural ownership.
- **Infrastructure Gaps**: High rentals, poor acoustics, rigid auditoriums, and a lack of digital integration limit access and experimentation. Affordable rehearsal studios, flexible halls, recording/livestream facilities, and climate-responsive open courts can revitalize creative diversity.
- **Stakeholder Disunity**: Government bodies, universities, and cultural trusts operate in silos, leading to duplication and inefficiency. A centralized arts hub enables coordinated governance, resource pooling, and long-term cultural planning.
- **Economic & Digital Absence**: Limited cultural tourism, no digital archives, and poor visibility weaken sustainability. A new centre can stimulate local creative industries, generate tourism, and establish digital revenue channels through streaming, archives, and online engagement.

Together, these factors clearly demonstrate the necessity of Kalagriha—a shared, modern, bilingual, digitally enabled arts centre—to address Belagavi's cultural, educational, infrastructural, socio-political, and economic gaps in one unified architectural and institutional intervention.

7. Conclusion to the Research

Kalagriha is conceived as a cultural catalyst for Belagavi—reviving performing arts, reconnecting linguistic identities, and empowering youth through integrated spaces for theatre, film-making, training, and community interaction. This chapter outlines the project's aims, measurable objectives, and the outcomes expected from a unified arts ecosystem. From an execution perspective, the proposal is structured to align with public-sector feasibility, prioritizing cost efficiency, phased implementation, and long-term operational sustainability. It positions Kalagriha as a practical, scalable cultural investment that can deliver measurable social and economic returns with manageable public expenditure.

7.1 Aims and Objectives of the Research

7.1.1 Aims

• Rebuild Belagavi's performing arts ecosystem and reconnect youth to live arts.
• Promote Kannada–Marathi cultural unity through inclusive programming.
• Integrate theatre, film-making, and digital arts under one multidisciplinary hub.
• Strengthen the creative economy through training, festivals, and tourism.

7.1.2 Objectives

• Create professional-grade auditoriums, rehearsal rooms, and film screening studios.
• Establish structured acting and film training with university collaboration.
• Host bilingual cultural events to foster shared artistic identity.
• Ensure affordability through subsidised rentals and student-led access.
• Build national/international partnerships for mentoring and residencies.

7.2 Conclusion to the Research Question

Kalagriha demonstrates that Belagavi's challenge is not talent scarcity but the absence of integrated spaces for creation, learning, and performance. By merging theatre, film, digital media, and community interfaces, the centre revitalizes cultural identity and youth engagement. As a model for mid-sized cities, it shows how inclusive cultural hubs can reduce migration, bridge divides, and revive local arts ecosystems.

Kalagriha unites Belagavi's art, history, society, and architecture—addressing linguistic divisions, supporting youth, and transforming art spaces into active agents of dialogue and creativity. More than a building, it becomes a symbol of cultural renewal for mid-sized Indian cities, proving that architecture can spark identity, collaboration, and long-term artistic resilience.

"Architecture has the power to not only house art and culture but to revive it, reshape it, and reimagine it for generations to come."

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